

## Chapter 23 — Passage Exercise: Reading the Clause in Context

BBH Chapter 23

For each highlighted clause: (a) identify the clause type, (b) identify any fronted element and its rhetorical function, (c) state the verb and its conjugation (if any), (d) supply the English gloss.

### Passage 1 — Genesis 1:1–4 (Creation Account)

| #      | Clause                          | Clause Type | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss |
|--------|---------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-------|
| ( 1:1) | בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים ... |             |                          |                    |       |
| ( 1:2) | וְהָאֶרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוֹ וָבֹהוּ |             |                          |                    |       |
| 3      | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים ( 1:3)       |             |                          |                    |       |
| 4      | כִּיטוֹב ( 1:4)                 |             |                          |                    |       |

### Passage 2 — Genesis 3:1–5 (The Serpent and Eve)

| #        | Clause                      | Clause Type | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss |
|----------|-----------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-------|
| 5 ( 3:1) | וְהַנָּחַשׁ הָיָה עָרֹם     |             |                          |                    |       |
| 6 ( 3:1) | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהֵי אִשָּׁה   |             |                          |                    |       |
| 7        | לֹא מֵוַת תִּמָּתוֹן ( 3:4) |             |                          |                    |       |

### Passage 3 — Deuteronomy 6:4–5 (The Shema)

| #      | Clause                           | Clause Type | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss |
|--------|----------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-------|
| 8      | שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל ( 6:4)         |             |                          |                    |       |
| ( 6:4) | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד   |             |                          |                    |       |
| ( 6:5) | וְאָהַבְתָּ אֶת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ |             |                          |                    |       |

### Passage 4 — Genesis 22:1–2 (The Binding of Isaac)

| #       | Clause                      | Clause Type | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss |
|---------|-----------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-------|
| 11      | וַאֲבִרְהָם זָקֵן           |             |                          |                    |       |
| ( 22:2) | אֶתִּיצְחָק אֲשֶׁר אֶהְבֵּת |             |                          |                    |       |

### Passage 5 — Judges 16:20 / Genesis 4:9 / Exodus 20:2 (Mixed)

| #  | Clause                        | Clause Type | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss |
|----|-------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-------|
| 13 | וְהוּא לֹא יָדָע ... (16:20)  |             |                          |                    |       |
| 14 | הָ/שֹׁמֵר אֹתִי אֲנִי (4:9)   |             |                          |                    |       |
| 15 | אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ (20:2) |             |                          |                    |       |

## Answer Key

### Passage 1 — Genesis 1:1–4 (Creation Account)

| #     | Clause                              | Clause Type     | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss                        |
|-------|-------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------|
| (1:1) | בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים ...     |                 |                          |                    |                              |
| ✓     | בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא ...              | Verbal — PP     | תִּשְׁאֲרָב (temporal)   | בָּרָא — Qal       | In the beginning God created |
| (1:2) | וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוֹ/וּ בְהוֹלָא |                 |                          |                    |                              |
| ✓     | וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה ...               | Waw-disjunctive | יָרָא/א (noun)           | הָיְתָה — Qal      | Now the earth was formless   |
| 3     | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים (1:3)            |                 |                          |                    |                              |
| ✓     | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים                  | Verbal VSO      | None                     | יֵאמַר —           | And God said                 |
| 4     | כִּיטוֹב (1:4)                      |                 |                          |                    |                              |
| ✓     | כִּיטוֹב                            | Verbless (י.כ.) | None                     | None               | that it was good             |

### Passage 2 — Genesis 3:1–5 (The Serpent and Eve)

| # | Clause                          | Clause Type     | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation  | Gloss                    |
|---|---------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|
| 5 | וְהַנָּחֹשׁ הָיָה עָרֹם (3:1)   |                 |                          |                     |                          |
| ✓ | וְהַנָּחֹשׁ הָיָה ...           | Waw-disjunctive | יָשָׁח/וּ (noun)         | הָיָה — Qal Perfect | Now the serpent was more |
| ¶ | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהֵי אִשָּׁה (3:1) |                 |                          |                     |                          |
| ✓ | וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהֵי אִשָּׁה       | Verbal VSO      | None                     | יֵאמַר —            | And he said to the woman |
| 7 | לֹא מוֹת תָּמוּתוּן (3:4)       |                 |                          |                     |                          |
| ✓ | לֹא מוֹת תָּמוּתוּן             | Verbal — IA     | תָּמוּ (Inf. Absolute)   | וְלֹא תָמוּת — Qal  | You will not surely die  |

### Passage 3 — Deuteronomy 6:4–5 (The Shema)

| # | Clause                                 | Clause Type   | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss                       |
|---|----------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|
| 8 | שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל (6:4)                |               |                          |                    |                             |
| ✓ | שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל                      | Verbal VSO    | None                     | שָׁמַע — Qal       | Hear, O Israel              |
|   | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד (6:4)   |               |                          |                    |                             |
| ✓ | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ ...                  | Verbless (×2) | None                     | None               | The LORD is our God; the    |
|   | וְאַהֲבַתְּ אֶת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ (6:5) |               |                          |                    |                             |
| ✓ | וְאַהֲבַתְּ ...                        | Verbal —      | None                     | אָהַבְתָּ —        | And you shall love the LORD |

### Passage 4 — Genesis 22:1–2 (The Binding of Isaac)

| #  | Clause                              | Clause Type     | Fronted Element (if any) | Verb & Conjugation | Gloss                |
|----|-------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|
| 11 | וַאֲבִרְהָם זָקֵן                   |                 |                          |                    |                      |
| ✓  | וַאֲבִרְהָם זָקֵן                   | Waw-disjunctive | אֲבִרְהָם (noun)         | None (verbless)    | Now Abraham was old  |
|    | אֶתִּיצְחָק אֲשֶׁר אָהַבְתָּ (22:2) |                 |                          |                    |                      |
| ✓  | אֶתִּיצְחָק אֲשֶׁר ...              | Verbal — Object | אֶתִּיצְחָק (direct      | אָהַבְתָּ — Qal    | Isaac, whom you love |

### Passage 5 — Judges 16:20 / Genesis 4:9 / Exodus 20:2 (Mixed)

| #  | Clause                          | Clause Type         | Fronted Element (if any)  | Verb & Conjugation  | Gloss                        |
|----|---------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|
| 13 | וְהוּא לֹא יָדָע ... (16:20)    |                     |                           |                     |                              |
| ✓  | וְהוּא לֹא יָדָע ...            | Waw-disjunctive     | הוּא (pronoun)            | יָדָע — Qal Perfect | but he did not know the LORD |
|    | הֲשֹׁמֵר אֲחִי אָנֹכִי (4:9)    |                     |                           |                     |                              |
| ✓  | הֲשֹׁמֵר אֲחִי אָנֹכִי          | Verbless            | הֲשֹׁמֵר (pred. ptc.) + ה | None (verbless)     | Am I my brother's keeper?    |
|    | אָנֹכִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ (20:2) |                     |                           |                     |                              |
| ✓  | אָנֹכִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ        | Verbless (identity) | None                      | None                | I am the LORD your God       |